03-12 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） The Long Journey of the Bicycle

① A bicycle today looks so simple that we almost forget how much clever work has gone into it. Two wheels, a chain, a light metal frame — and off we go to school. But behind this everyday "iron horse" lies **more than 200 years** of slow, step-by-step invention.

② The earliest "bicycle" was not at all like ours. In 1817, a German named Karl Drais built a strange wooden machine with two wheels in a line. It had no pedals and no chain. Riders pushed the ground with their feet, as if running while sitting on a small wooden bench. People called it a "running machine". It moved faster than walking, but going up a hill was still very hard work.

③ A bigger step forward came in 1861 in France. The Michaux family added **pedals** to the front wheel. Now riders could sit down and push with their feet instead of running. This new bike was called the "bone-shaker", because its iron frame and wooden wheels shook almost every bone in the rider's body. Still, people loved it: for the first time, riding could be faster and less tiring than walking.

④ In 1885 in England, **John Starley** built a bike that looks much like our modern one. It had two wheels of the **same size**, a metal chain turning the back wheel, and a comfortable seat. A few years later, another English man, John Dunlop, invented the **air tyre** to help his sick son ride more smoothly. Air tyres ended the shaking pain of the old wooden wheels, and bicycles quickly became popular around the world.

⑤ China got its first bicycles in the 1860s, but for a long time, they were expensive and rare. In the 1980s, things changed: China became known as the **"Kingdom of Bicycles"**. Streets in Beijing and Shanghai were filled with black and silver bikes riding home from work. In recent years, **shared bicycles** — the colourful ones you can unlock with a phone — have brought the bicycle back into the centre of city life, especially for short trips of less than three kilometres.

⑥ Today, some people still believe the bicycle is an "old" machine, but scientists love its quiet power. A bike makes no smoke, needs no fuel, and uses the rider's own body to move. It helps us stay strong, keeps the air clean, and eases busy traffic. From a wooden bench in Germany to a blue share-bike outside your school gate, the bicycle has travelled a long road — and its journey is still going on.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What did Karl Drais's "running machine" need to move forward?

A. A chain turning the back wheel.
B. The rider pushing the ground with his feet.
C. A small engine under the seat.
D. Two small balls of air.

2. Why was the 1861 French bicycle called the "bone-shaker"?

A. It was made of animal bones.
B. Its iron frame and wooden wheels shook almost every bone in the rider's body.
C. It could only run on very hard stones.
D. It had too many small bells.

3. What is true about the bicycle built by John Starley in 1885?

A. It had two wheels of different sizes.
B. It had a wooden chain.
C. It looked much like our modern bicycle.
D. It was used only by children.

4. Why did John Dunlop invent the air tyre?

A. To make the bicycle look nicer.
B. To help his sick son ride more smoothly.
C. To make the bicycle cheaper.
D. To replace the metal chain.

5. According to the last paragraph, what is ONE good thing about the bicycle today?

A. It makes thick smoke every morning.
B. It needs a lot of fuel to run.
C. It keeps the air clean and helps us stay strong.
D. It is only useful for long trips over 50 kilometres.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "Riders pushed the ground with their feet"
【解析】靠脚蹬地推动。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B

【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "its iron frame and wooden wheels shook almost every bone"
【解析】铁框+木轮剧烈震动。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "a bike that looks much like our modern one"
【解析】该车外形已接近现代自行车。A 与 "same size" 相反；B "wooden chain" 无依据；D 无依据。故选 C。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "invented the air tyre to help his sick son ride more smoothly"
【解析】为帮生病的儿子而发明充气轮胎。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨/细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "helps us stay strong, keeps the air clean"
【解析】自行车利于健康与清洁空气。A、B、D 与文意相反或无依据。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **pedal** [n.] 脚踏板
- **tyre / tire** [n.] 轮胎
- **frame** [n.] 车架